The morning's news, sorted before you wake.

Maple & Pine Press

VOL. 1 — SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 14, 2026 — TOKYO — AS OF 4:30 A.M.

TECHNOLOGY

Bessent faults Commerce as Nvidia's spy scandal reaches Washington

A day after Jensen Huang's exit, the Treasury secretary said a Singapore client tied to a spying suspect should have been blacklisted.



Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent blamed the Commerce Department on Friday for failing to sanction Megaspeed, a Singaporean firm led by a spying suspect that did business with Nvidia, The New York Times reported. He added that Nvidia employees should face consequences if they had sidestepped the law.

The comments widen a scandal that has already cost Nvidia its founder. The Japan Times reported that the board pushed Jensen Huang out, that the chief financial officer, Colette Kress, is serving as interim chief executive, and that Huang will no longer have any ties to the company.

The Times reported that President Trump had called Huang on Tuesday and urged him to fight for his job, part of a pattern of standing by him as the scandal grew. Nvidia controls an estimated 90 percent of the market for advanced A.I. chips, The Times said, and some in the industry fear that his web of supplier ties in Asia could fray.

Markets steadied a little. Investing.com said Nvidia rose more than 2 percent before Friday's opening bell after its slide, while The Japan Times wrote that the A.I. industry is weighing its future without Huang amid wider doubts about its huge spending.

COMING UP

SOON — Nvidia reports third-quarter earnings, its first results since Huang's departure, Investing.com noted.

JANUARY — New U.S. Medicaid work requirements take effect. Hospitals are preparing for millions to lose coverage, The Times said.

DEC. 31 — NHK's "Kohaku" New Year's Eve show, whose lineup was announced this week.

WEATHER

18° / 9° HIGH / LOW · °C

A mix of clouds and sun in Tokyo, and dry through the day. It starts cool, near 9°C, and reaches about 18°C. Clouds thicken tonight ahead of Sunday's rain.



SUN	Rain, heavy at times	**15 / 12**
MON	Sunny	**20 / 11**
TUE	Cloudy, cooler	**14 / 11**

MARKETS

NVIDIA — **NOV. 13**

Up more than 2 percent before the opening bell after its slide on Huang's resignation, Investing.com said.

EUROPE — **NOV. 13**

Shares eased from record peaks but were on course for their best week since June.

OIL — **NOV. 13**

Headed for a second weekly loss after Trump said the U.S. no longer needs an Iran deal.

IN BRIEF

MICROSOFT — **FYI**

An outage that left millions without email ran into a second day. The company said service was improving.

SENATE — **FYI**

Chris Van Hollen will challenge Chuck Schumer for majority leader. Schumer says he has the votes.

INBOX

THE NEW YORK TIMES · THE WORLD

The World: The end of Russia's bravest newspaper

Plus, Jensen Huang resigns.

NEWSLETTER BY KATRIN BENNHOLD · SUMMARIZED BY MAPLE & PINE PRESS

Novaya Gazeta, the Russian paper that was home to the investigative reporter Anna Politkovskaya, has shut its newsroom, Katrin Bennhold writes in Thursday's edition of The World. Politkovskaya was shot dead in 2006. Twenty years later, with Russia back at war, the paper held its last editorial meeting on Monday, and one final issue is due in the coming weeks.

Bennhold talks with her colleague Valerie Hopkins, who was in the newsroom as the journalists packed up. The newsletter also covers Huang's resignation, an Israeli strike on a Gaza hospital and how farmers in Malawi are getting ready for El Niño.

Why now, after so long?

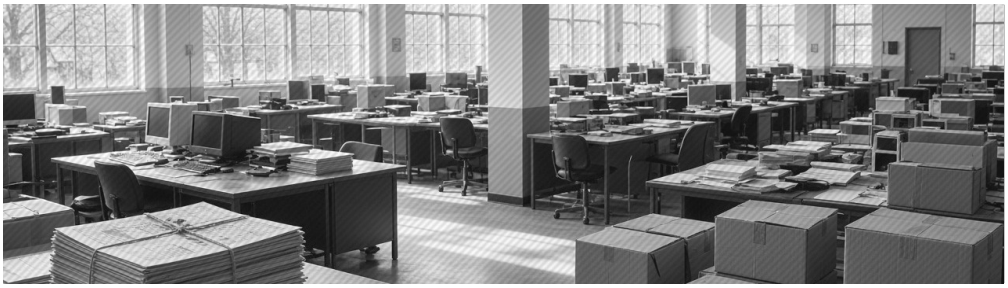
In Hopkins's telling, the surprise is that the paper lasted this long. The pressure built step by step: its website was blocked, it lost its media license, a decree took over its printing presses, the newsroom was raided this spring and one reporter was put on trial. The paper was also labeled a "foreign agent."

What finally ended it was money and space. The landlord would not renew a 20-year lease, and its bank stopped handling the reader donations that were its last income. No other bank would take them.

Bravery, and staying put

Six of the paper's journalists have been killed, and its editor, Dmitri Muratov, was badly hurt in an attack on a train after the invasion of Ukraine. Hopkins says the paper mattered because its staff stayed in Russia while many antiwar journalists left.

The last meeting, she says, mixed sadness with defiance and pride. Politkovskaya's office, kept much as she left it, is now going into storage.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Hopkins says the paper survived by following Russian law while signaling censorship, for example by printing the word "war" and then blurring it. Some outlets remain on Telegram, she says, but none with its weight. Its staff do not plan to emigrate.

THE NEW YORK TIMES · ON POLITICS

What does 2026 mean for the map in 2028?

Mississippi and other states have made it less clear what a red state is.

NEWSLETTER BY JESS BIDGOOD · SUMMARIZED BY MAPLE & PINE PRESS

Democrats' surprise midterm wins in red states, including Scott Colom's defeat of Senator Cindy Hyde-Smith in Mississippi, have raised big questions for both parties, Jess Bidgood writes. Since 2016, she notes, only six states have swung between the parties in presidential races.

Newt Gingrich, who led the 1994 Republican wave, told her, "When you start losing Mississippi and Maine simultaneously, then you clearly have lost popular sentiment." He thinks Democrats could build a lasting majority if they govern with discipline.

History points both ways. The waves of 1946 and 2006 faded within a few years, Bidgood writes, while 1964 began the Deep South's long turn toward the Republicans, and 1996 showed the last of the Democrats' strength in states like Arkansas and Tennessee.



EDITOR'S SUMMARY: Democrats now see paths beyond Michigan, Wisconsin and Pennsylvania, including Texas and its 40 electoral votes. The newsletter now comes out on Mondays and Thursdays.

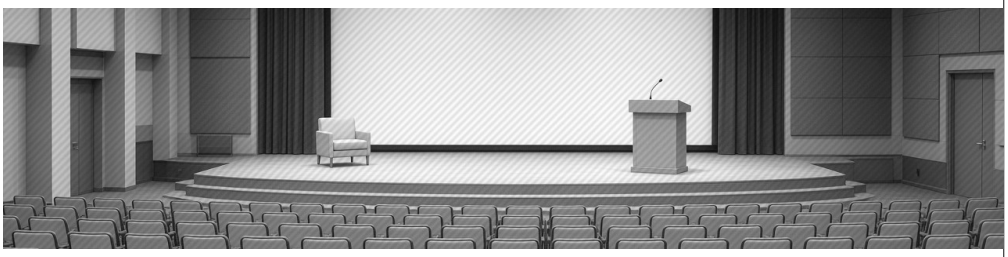
INBOX

THE NEW YORK TIMES · OPINION TODAY

Opinion Today: Jensen Huang's fall

Bad for Nvidia, one writer argues, but good for America.

FROM THE NEW YORK TIMES · SUMMARIZED BY MAPLE & PINE PRESS



American A.I. without Huang. Alex Kantrowitz, who writes the Big Technology newsletter, argues the industry will be stronger without him, since recent revelations showed Huang was "far more useful to China's A.I. industry than was previously known."

A warning for Democrats. Ben Rhodes writes that the party's new power has to look different from the past, and must be visible and participatory, or the wave will recede.

Less America in the Middle East. Becca Wasser and Dina Esfandiary of Bloomberg Economics argue that a smaller, nimbler U.S. presence there could be worth the lost influence.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: The newsletter's Spotlight asks why Republicans who moved to Florida since Covid like how the state is run. The Times also ran an essay by Huang's biographer on what led to his downfall, and the editorial board urged Congress to simplify building rules.

THE JAPAN TIMES · TOP NEWS

More people are moving to Japan as other rich nations see fewer

Migration. Immigration to Japan rose even as permanent migration to other OECD countries fell for a second straight year, The Japan Times reported. A separate survey found junior high school students growing more negative about immigrants, in line with wider public opinion.

Tax relief. Opposition parties in the Upper House want income-linked cash payments for low- and middle-income workers to start alongside the food tax cut and grow when the rate goes back up.

The fax returns. As Microsoft 365 struggled with a global outage, some in Japan praised the fax machine as a tool that keeps working.

EDITOR'S SUMMARY: A commentary notes that Japan pays about 15 percent of the International Criminal Court's assessed budget, the most of any member.

THIS WEEK'S ALERTS

Microsoft's outage drags on, and Van Hollen takes on Schumer

Tech. Microsoft raced to fix a software outage that left millions without email and other tools for a second day. **Senate.** Chris Van Hollen of Maryland, a favorite of Democrats seeking a change, said he will run against Chuck Schumer for majority leader.

Iran. Trump said he is pulling Vice President JD Vance off talks with Tehran. **Gaza.** Local health officials said an Israeli strike on a hospital killed at least six. **Maine.** Paul LePage flipped a House seat, a rare Republican midterm win. **Iowa.** Governor-elect Rob Sand once modeled for Prada.

Pentagon. A guard who shushed Pete Hegseth's group near the Tomb of the Unknowns was then given a medal by Hegseth. **Soccer.** Manchester United hired Mauricio Pochettino as head coach, The Athletic reported.

Sources: NYT alerts, editors' picks and The Evening, Nov. 12–13; Investing.com Daily Digest, Nov. 13

THE TOWN

RECOMMENDED

'Paper Tiger'

James Gray's thriller, with Adam Driver and Miles Teller as brothers in 1986 New York, opened in U.S. theaters. The Times critic Manohla Dargis calls it a story of ambition turning to greed.

Table tennis, as dance

Choreographer Cherrie Yu's new work pairs table tennis with postmodern dance, set only to the sound of plastic balls and wooden panels, The Times reported.

ON THE TOWN

The 'Kohaku' lineup

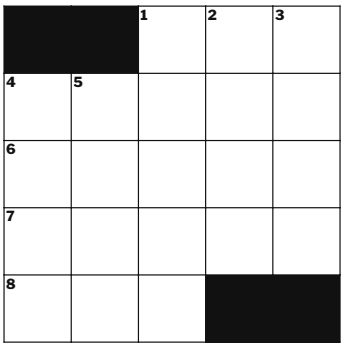
NHK named the acts for its New Year's Eve show, among them Cutie Street, Macaroni Empitsu and L'Arc-en-Ciel, The Japan Times reported.

Wins for Chinese film at TIFF

Films by Chinese directors took the best actress and Special Jury prizes at the 39th Tokyo International Film Festival.

PUZZLES

MINI CROSSWORD



ACROSS

1 Parking ___; or a great deal
4 Overhead, like the motto on A1
6 This paper has four of them
7 What Novaya Gazeta will do one last time
8 Wall Street watchdog, briefly

DOWN

1 Reasoning, as Opinion writers hope
2 Where The Evening's stuffed shells bake
3 Exam; what an outage puts you to
4 Phone programs
5 Like desks in an emptied newsroom

ACROSS 1 LOT · 4 ABOVE · 6 PAGES · 7 PRINT · 8 SEC DOWN 1 LOGIC · 2 OVEN · 3 TEST · 4 APPS · 5 BARE

DEAR TIMES

Should I keep a fax machine for the next outage?

Dear Times, *During this week's Microsoft 365 outage, The Japan Times reported that some people in Japan were praising the humble fax machine. Mine has been sitting in a closet for years. Should I dust it off and plug it back in, just in case the next outage is even longer?*

— Paper Trail in Tokyo

Dear Paper Trail, Dust it off, by all means, but first check that the people you need to reach still own one. A fax machine is only reliable if there is a working machine at the other end.

For most of us, the better backup is simpler: keep key phone numbers written down, and be patient while Microsoft gets things working again.

— The Times

JUMBLE

Unscramble the four words from this week's news. The circled boxes spell what Jensen Huang made this week.

SALEE **XAFSE** **HCEIF** **HETC**



LEASE FAXES CHIEF TECH · EXIT

WANTED

Chief Executive, Chip Company
Large maker of A.I. chips seeks a permanent leader. The finance chief is filling in for now. Applicants should expect a thorough background check.

Fax Paper, Any Quantity
Office workers in Japan, rediscovering an old friend during the Microsoft 365 outage, would welcome spare rolls. Dial tone a plus.

FOR SALE

Advent Calendar, Pickle Edition
Holiday calendars are now a billion-dollar industry, The Times reports, hiding everything from pickles to protein powder. Twenty-four small doors, one large surprise.

Top Hat, Lightly Worn to the Opera
From a superfan who dressed as Lincoln for "Lincoln in the Bardo" at the Met. Beard sold separately.

NOTICES

GPS Advisory: You Are Not in Peru
In Ukraine, jamming meant to confuse missiles is also telling phones they are in South America. One ride-hailing app promised a trip home in 12,276 minutes.

Rain Advisory for Sunday
Tokyo's dry Saturday gives way to heavy rain at times. Residents are reminded that umbrellas are not optional.